INCH-POUND

A-A-55066
15 July 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

NEEDLES, EXCEPT SURGICAL, HAND

This Commercial Item Description is authorized for use in preference to FF-N-180.

Abstract. This commercial item description covers hand needles, except surgical, used in sewing, and for packaging and packing various items.

Classification. The needles shall be in the following types, classes, and styles:

Type I - Straight.
Class 1 - Round point.
Style B - Upholsterer's (double point).
Class 2 - Three square point, glover's.
Class 3 - Diamond point, packing.
Class 4 - Harness, blunt point.

Type II - Bent (at point only) packing.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Clothing and Textiles Directorate, Attn: DPSC-FSSD, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101-8419, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A

FSC 8315

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Type III - Curved.
Class 1 - Round point (regular).
Class 2 - Three-square point.

Construction. Each hand needle shall have a ground point as indicated in Tables I through VII and shall blend in shape with the body of the needle directly in back of the point. The spreading edges of the triangular and diamond sections (when applicable) shall be ground and rounded in a manner to prevent material fibers from being cut when pierced by the needle in the normal sewing operation. The eye of the needles shall be centered between the lateral edges and shall be designed to prevent cutting of the thread or cord in ordinary use. Type I and II needles shall not break or take a permanent set when subjected to horizontally applied force as described under "Deflection Test". Type III needles shall not break or take a permanent set when a force is applied simultaneously to the eye and point. The force is measured by bending the eye and point simultaneously to reduce its length when bent by 25% (see figures 6 and 7).

Material. The material used in the manufacture of hand needles covered by this Commercial Item Description shall be of tool steel normally used in commercial practice. The needles shall be hardened and tempered in accordance with the best commercial practice for this type of commodity.

Size and duty. The size and duty (extra, light or heavy) of the hand needles shall be as listed in Tables I through VII under the respective types, classes, and styles.

Table I. Type I, class 1, style B, straight, round point, double, upholsterer's *

Size (length L) ± 1/8 Inch	Section BB diameter (+/- 0.005 inch)		
	Extra light	Light	Heavy
Inches	Inch	Inch	Inch
8	-----	0.080	0.092
10	0.080	.092	.104
12	.080	.092	.104
14	.080	.092	.104
16	.080	.104	.116

* Style B needles shall be similar to Figure 1.

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Table II. Type I, class 4, straight, blunt point, harness *

Commercial size	Length L	Section BB diameter (± 0.005 inch
	Inches	Inch
0	2-1/4 -- 2-1/2	0.048
2	2-1/16 -- 2-3/16	.040
3	2 -- 2-1/8	.040
4	1-13/16 -- 1-15/16	.036
6	1-9/16 -- 1-3/4	.032

* Class 4 needles shall be similar to Figure 2.

Table III. Type I, class 2, straight, three-square point, glover's *

Commercial size	Length L	Section BB diameter (± 0.005 inch
	Inches	Inch
000	2-1/16 -- 2-1/8	0.064
00	2-1/16 -- 2-1/8	.051
0	1-7/8 -- 2	.051
1	1-13/16 -- 1-15/16	.048
2	1-13/16 -- 1-7/8	.043
3	1-9/16 -- 1-11/16	.040
4	1-5/8 -- 1-11/16	.036
6	1-1/2 -- 1-5/8	.028
8	1-1/4 -- 1-3/8	.024

* Glover needles shall be similar to Figure 3.

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Table IV. Type I, class 3, straight, diamond point, packing *

Size (length L) ± 1/8 inch	Section BB diameter (± 0.005 inch)
Inches	Inch
6	0.144

* Class 3 needles shall be similar to Figure 4.

Table V. Type II, bent, packing *

Size (length L) ± 1/8 inch	Section BB diameter (± 0.005 inch)
Inches	Inch
3	0.080
4	.104
5	.128
6	.144
7	.160

* Type II needles shall be similar to Figure 5.

Table VI. Type III, class 1, curved, round point, regular *

Size (length L) ± 1/8 inch	W (approx-imate)	Section BB diameter (+/- 0.005 inch)		
		Extra light	Light	Heavy
Inches	Inches	Inch	Inch	Inch
2-1/2	1-3/4	0.036	0.048	----
4	2-3/4	.048	.064	0.072
4-1/2	3	---	.064	.072
5	3-3/8	---	.064	.080
8	5-1/4	---	.072	.092

* Class 1 needles shall be similar to Figure 6.

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Table VII. Type III, class 2, curved, three-square point *

Size (length L) ± 1/8 inch	W (approx-imate)	Section BB diameter (± 0.005 inch)		
		Extra light	Light	Heavy
Inches	Inches	Inch	Inch	Inch
3	2	0.040	0.048	0.064
5	3-3/8	-----	.064	.080

* Class 2 needles shall be similar to Figure 7.

Finish. The needle surfaces shall be nickel plated in accordance with standard commercial practice for this type of commodity.

Workmanship. After completion, the finished needles shall be smooth and free of burrs, slivers, nicks, pitholes, and scratches.

Product Demonstration Model. When required, offerers shall submit samples of their intended production. The Product Demonstration Model will consist of units independently developed. Product Demonstration Models will be analyzed and evaluated by the government. Evaluation criteria and basis for award are contained in the solicitation. Product Demonstration Models will be retained by the government. One (1) Product Demonstration Model approved by DPSC under the resultant contract will serve as a manufacturing standard for the corresponding production items delivered under this contract. Offerers are advised that the Product Demonstration Model does not relieve the successful offerer of his responsibility to perform in accordance with the Commercial Item Description specified above.

Quality Assurance

Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for, under the provisions of the contract.

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Examination. Lots of needles shall be inspected in accordance with "Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes", ANSI/ASQC Z1.4, published by the American Society for Quality Control.

Visual Examination. The inspection level for visual examination shall be II and the AQL 2.5 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units. The sample unit is one needle.

Dimensional Examination. The finished needles shall conform to the dimensions specified. Any dimension that is not within the established tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The sample unit shall be one needle; the inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

Packaging Examination. The fully packaged shipping containers shall be examined in accordance with defects listed below. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-4 and AQL shall be 2.5 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

Examination	Defect
Material	Missing, damaged, not as required.
Content	Number of needles per shipping container is more or less than required.

Defects. The needles shall be examined for the following defects: surface (including periphery of the eye) is not smooth; evidence of imbedded foreign matter; does not have fine sharp point; edge of triangular or diamond section (when applicable) not ground and rounded; eye not centered between lateral edges; eye is closed; eye is partially closed; sharp edge at eye (inside or outside); burrs or slivers not removed; needle is cracked, broken or fractured; evidence of pitholes, nicks or scratches.

End Item Performance Testing. Needles shall be tested a minimum of 3 times as specified in the deflection test. Any deviation shall constitute a defect.

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Deflection test.

Type I and II needles up to and including 7 inches in length. Needles up to and including 7 inches in length shall be deflected a linear distance with Table VIII.

Table VIII. Deflections for needles up to and including 7 inches in length *
(Part 1)

Size (length L) inches	Deflection for sectional BB (inches)						
	0.024	0.028	.0.032	0.036	0.040	.0.043	.0.048
1-5/16	1/8						
1-9/16		5/32					
1-5/8					1/8		
1-11/16			3/16	5/32			
1-7/8				7/32		3/16	5/32
2							
2-1/16					1/4		
2-1/8					1/4		
2-3/8							9/32
2-1/2							5/16
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							

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Table VIII. Deflections for needles up to and including 7 inches in length * (Part 2)

Size (length L) inches	Deflection for sectional BB (inches)						
	0.051	0.064	.0.080	0.104	0.128	.0.144	.0.160
1-5/16							
1-9/16							
1-5/8							
1-11/16							
1-7/8							
2	5/32						
2-1/16							
2-1/8	3/16	5/32					
2-3/8							
2-1/2							
3			9/32				
4				3/8			
5					1/2		
6						21/32	
7							13/16

* Needles shall also be in accordance with Figure 8.

Type I needles from 8 inches up to and including 16 inches in length. Needles from 8 inches up to and including 16 inches in length shall be deflected a linear distance with Table IX.

Table IX. Deflections for needles of 8 inches up to and including 16 inches in length *

Size (length L) inches	Deflection for sectional sizes BB (inches)				
	0.072	0.080	0.092	0.104	0.116
8	1-7/32	1-1/16	1 5/16		
10		1-15/16	1-9/32	1-1/8	
12		1-29/32	1-21/32	1-7/16	
14		2-5/16	2	1-25/32	
16		2-23/32		2-3/16	1-7/8

* Needles shall also be in accordance with Figure 9.

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Type II needles. Needles shall be reduced in length "W" (see Figure 6) of at least 25 percent to determine compliance.

Packaging, Packing, Marking, and Palletization

Packaging, packing, marking and palletization shall be in accordance with ASTM-D 3951, Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging, as specified for shipments to the Department of Defense, including Section 7.

Note: Each shipping container shall contain only one National Stock Number (NSN).

Unitized loads, placing boxes on pallets, shall be used whenever total quantity for shipment to one destination exceeds 250 pounds (excluding the pallet) or 20 cubic feet. Pallets shall have a length of 40 inches and a width of 48 inches. Pallet loads, including the pallet, shall not exceed 54 inches in height, 43 inches in length and 52 inches in width.

The containers shall be bonded onto wing type commercial 4-way entry pallets.

Note: All palletized loads shall contain only one NSN, to the maximum extent possible. When there is less than a pallet load per NSN, pallets may have containers not of the same NSN, but the pallet shall be clearly marked "mixed" and each applicable NSN shall be listed together with its total quantity.

Source of Government Documents. Copies of Military and Federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Bldg. 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

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Sources of Nongovernment Documents.

ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables For Inspection By Attributes

(Applications for copies should be addressed to American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018-3308.)

ASTM-D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Applications for copies should be addressed to American Society For Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

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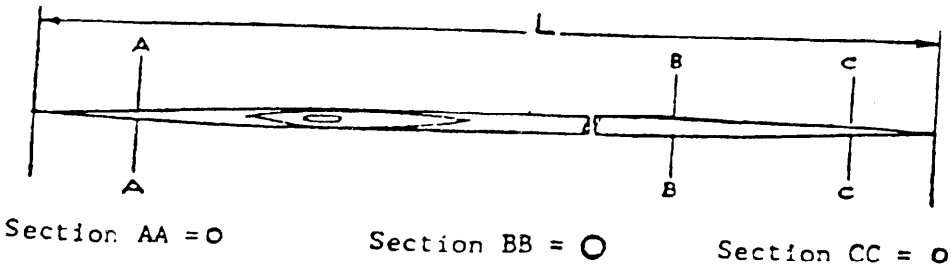


Figure 1. Type I, class 1, style B, straight, round point, double, upholsterer's.

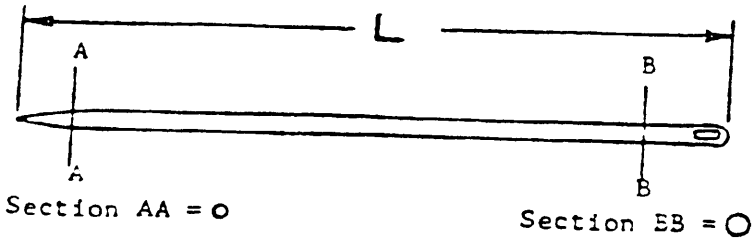


Figure 2. Type I, class 4, straight, blunt point, harness.

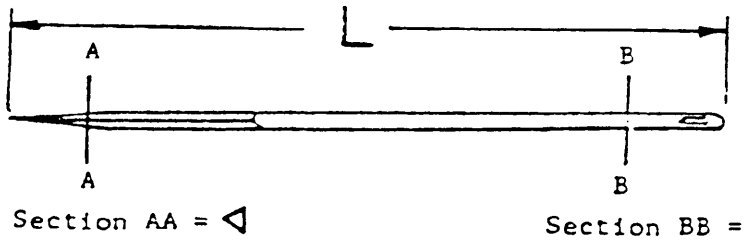


Figure 3. Type I, class 2, straight, three-square point, glover's.

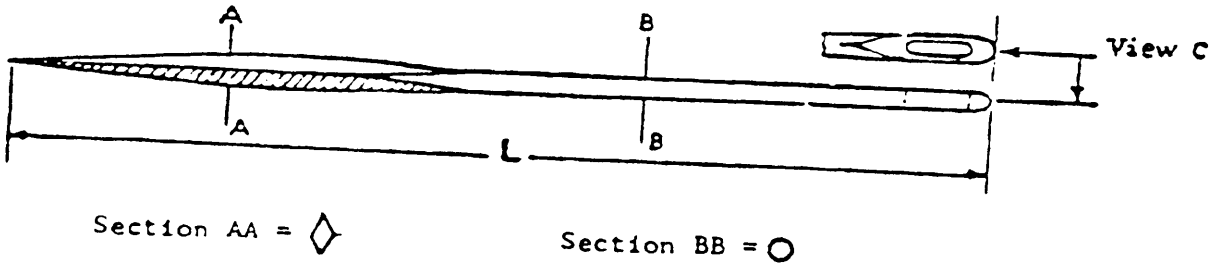


Figure 4. Type I, class 3, straight, packing.

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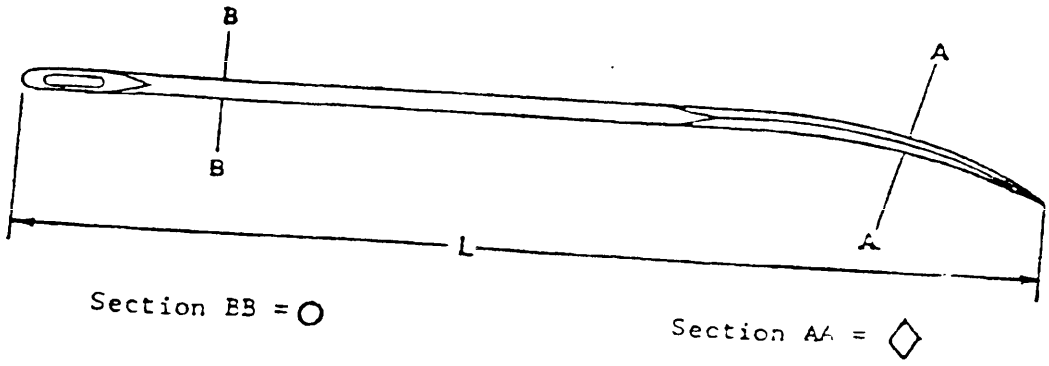


Figure 5. Type II, bent, packing.

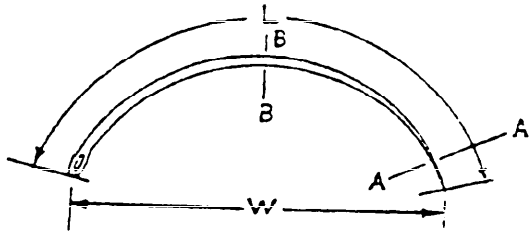


Figure 6. Type III, class 1, curved, round point, regular.

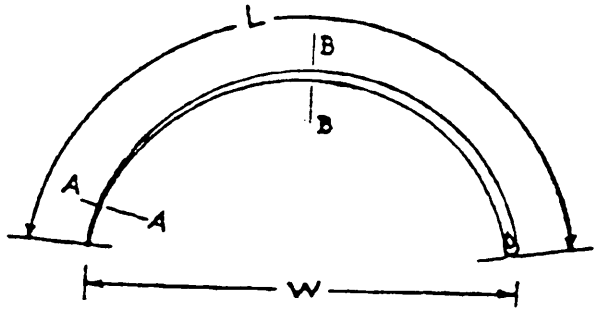


Figure 7. Type III, class 2, curved, three-square point.

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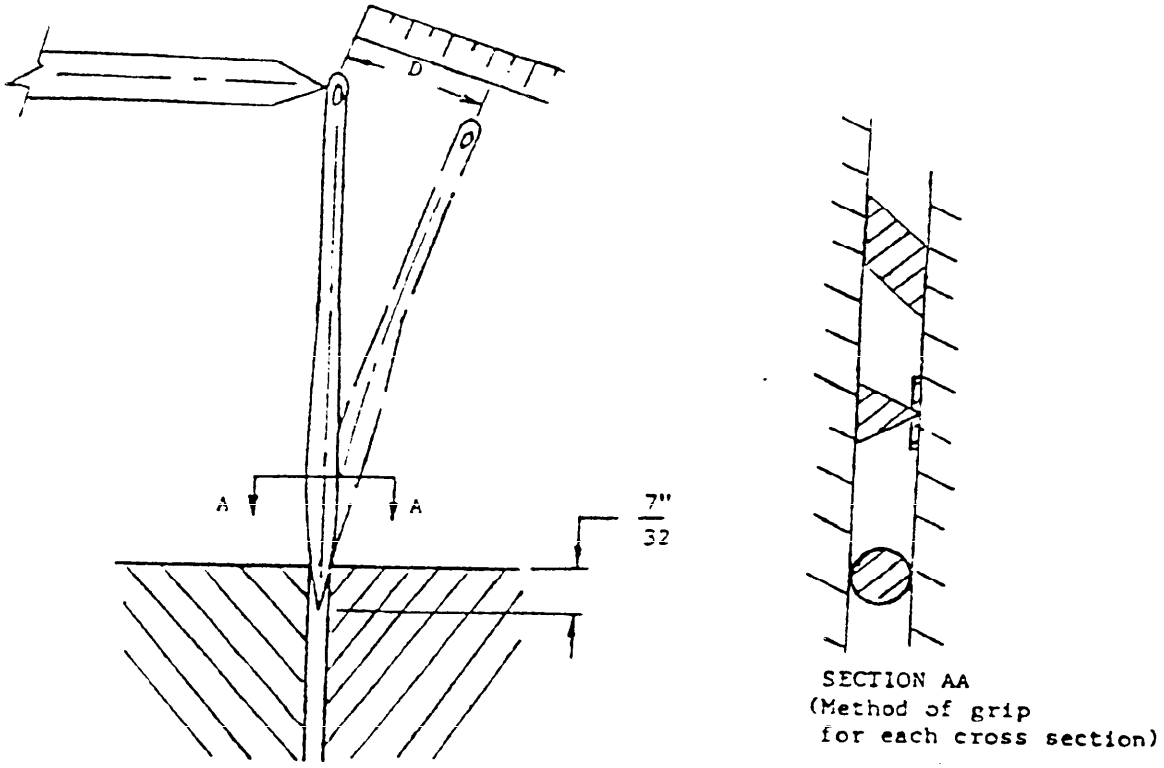


Figure 8. Deflection test for needles up to and including 7 inches in length.

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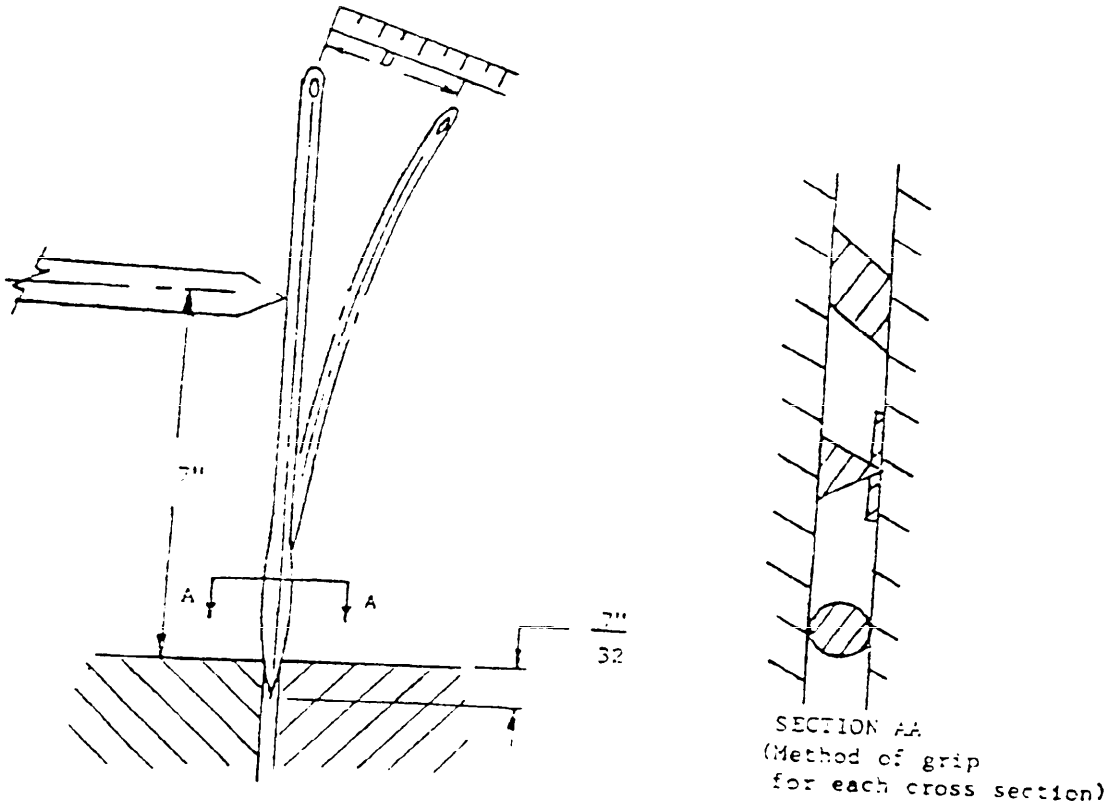


Figure 9. Deflection test for needles of 8 up to and including 16 inches in length.

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3. DOCUMENT TITLE
Needles, Except Surgical, Hand

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

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c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	c. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

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